

- Globally, about half of the conferences are medical conferences. BHU is well known for its medical schools and there are many prominent researchers at BHU. The Faculty of Medicine, BHU is now working to host the Annual Conference of ISCCM (Indian Society of Clinical Care Medicine) in 2018, but is facing difficulties to secure appropriate facilities. Cooperation with researchers will be a key to invite international conferences.
- Lucknow is the state capital of Uttar Pradesh. Private companies and government organizations in UP are concentrated in Lucknow. Varanasi has few opportunities to host corporate seminars and meetings of government agencies, thus the city needs to make efforts in actively attracting events. However, there are cases where companies conduct incentive tours combined with sightseeing in Varanasi. Also, due to the increase of infrastructure projects in recent years, donor agencies and infrastructure-related companies are increasingly holding seminars.
- Also, there are possibilities of academic conferences in India, organized by BHU professors specialized in medical fields.

(7) Improvement of Tourist Attractions Inside and Outside the City

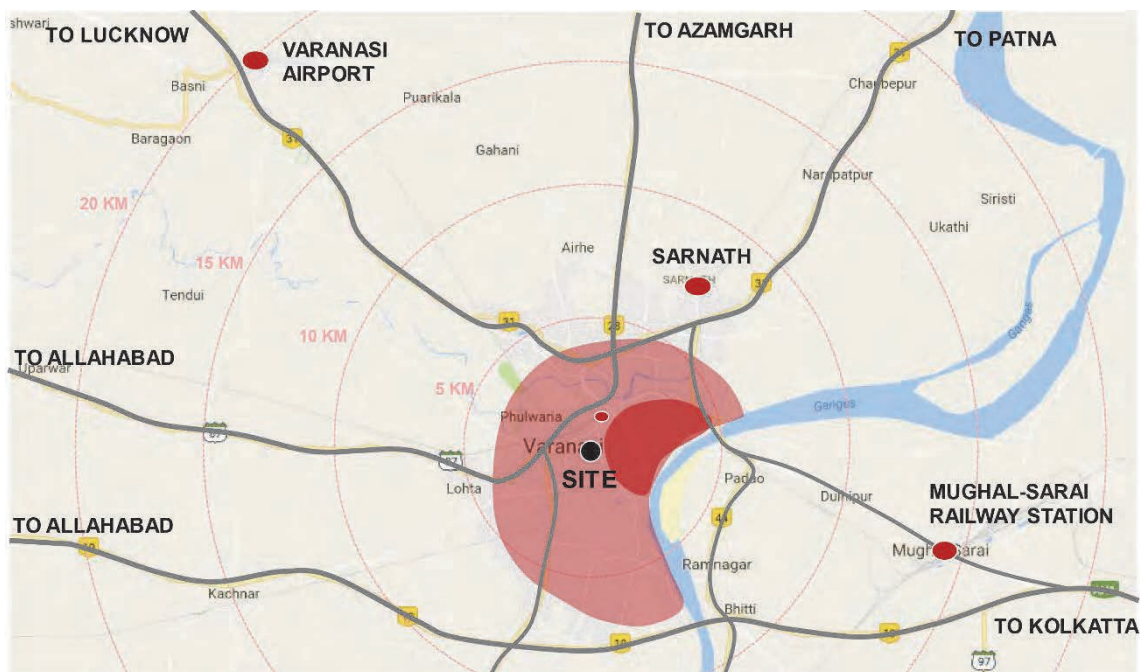
Varanasi has notable tourist attractions such as the Ganges River and Sarnath. However, access, traffic congestions and sanitation need to be improved.

- Although MICE is held as a part of business, the probability of attracting participants may increase if an event is held in a famous tourist place. Indeed, many global tourist cities such as Paris and Vienna are included in the world famous MICE host cities.
- Since Varanasi has many tourist attractions, sightseeing programs after conferences or company incentive tours can be planned.
- On the other hand, problems such as inconvenience in access to Varanasi, traffic congestion in the city and poor sanitation have been pointed out. The environment must be improved.

5.3. Condition of the Site and Surrounding Area

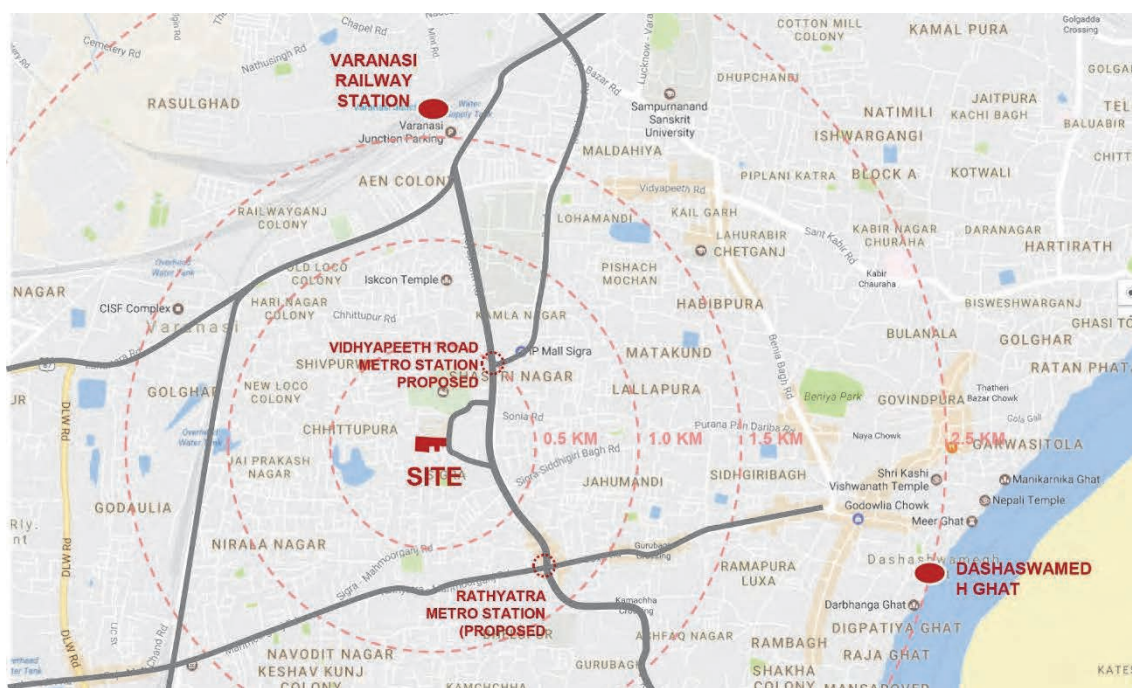
5.3.1. Accessibility to the Site

The proposed project site is located within the premises of Varanasi Municipal Corporation (hereinafter referred to as “VMC”) and is adjacent to the main building of VMC. The site is approximately 1.7 km from Varanasi Junction, the main railway station, 2.3 km from the Main Bus Stand and 24 km from Lal Bahadur Shastri International airport. From a tourism perspective, the site is located close to Varanasi Old City (3 Km from Dashaswamedh Ghat) and approximately 15 km from Sarnath Heritage Site. The site is situated off Srigra Chauraha Road, very close to Dr. Sampurnanad Sport Stadium and well linked with public commuter facilities (bus, taxi & auto) within 500m. The proposed underground Metro line has its two proposed stations of Kashi Vidyapeeth and Rathyatra almost equidistant from the site at a walkable distance of 750 m. For all practical purposes, the 18m wide Srigra Chauraha Road (city arterial road) is the main connectivity to the site.



Source: Google Maps + JST

Figure 5.3.1 Accessibility to the Site (Regional Level)



Source: Google Maps + JST

Figure 5.3.2 Accessibility to the Site (City Level)